

Voice Recovery Experience (VRX)

Rebuilding first-time job seekers' trust in ChatGPT mobile voice input

Team: ChatGPT India Mobile

Contributors: Product, Design, ASR/STT, Data Science

Status: In Review

Launching on: A/B test target - 8 week build

Resources: Milestone 2 research, M3 solution framework, voice UX competitive notes

Problem Definition

First-time job seekers abandon voice after one failed attempt, especially when Hinglish or accent recognition breaks.

- The problem is not discoverability alone; it is trust collapse after an early inaccurate transcript.
- The target users are 21-26 year old job seekers in Tier 1/2 Indian cities using ChatGPT for resumes, interview prep, LinkedIn drafts, and applications.
- Solving it unlocks repeat voice usage, deeper mobile sessions, and a higher-frequency job-search workflow.
- Users benefit because voice is faster than typing and lets them speak naturally during stressful career tasks.
- It is urgent because Gemini, Siri, Google Assistant, WhatsApp voice, and Indian voice AI products are setting expectations for natural speech.

Goals

Describe measurable outcomes in priority order.

- Increase D7 repeat voice use among new India mobile users from about 18% to $\geq 35\%$ within 90 days.
- Reduce abandonment after the first failed voice attempt by 40%.
- Improve self-reported voice confidence from 3.1 to $\geq 4.0/5$.

Non-Goals

Define what this v1 intentionally does not solve.

- Do not solve model-layer ASR/STT accuracy in this initiative.
- Do not build full voice onboarding for every new user.
- Do not scope Advanced Voice Mode or a regional-language launch in v1.

Validation of the problem

Research shows that failure is both functional and emotional.

- 78% of surveyed users who tried voice did not use it again after the first session.
- 64% cited incorrect understanding, especially Hinglish and mixed-language phrasing.
- 52% described embarrassment or feeling stupid after a failed attempt.
- Only 12% saw guidance explaining what went wrong or how to try again.

Understanding the target audience

Help the reader empathise with the job seeker segment.

- Primary persona: Riya, 23, B.Com graduate in Indore, applying to 8-12 jobs per week and using ChatGPT during commutes.
- Unmet need: she wants to speak naturally in Hinglish without mentally translating into formal English.
- Current journey: taps mic, speaks a job-search query, gets a garbled result, types the correction, and stops trusting the mic.

Solution Directions

We evaluated three different bets using the Effort, Impact, and Confidence framework.

Impact = expected positive delta. Effort = how hard it is to create. Confidence = how sure we are this will work. Ideal pick: high impact + low effort + high confidence.

Solution direction	Effort	Impact	Confidence	Why
Voice Recovery Coach (chosen)	Medium	High	High	Directly repairs the failed voice moment with live transcript, recovery card, editable retry, and tailored tips.
Voice Learner Mode	Medium-High	Medium-High	Medium	Siri-like practice mode where users speak sample commands so the app can recognize accent, pace, and Hinglish style.
Contextual Voice Nudge	Low-Med	Medium	Medium	Prompts voice on long job-search queries, but does not solve trust after an error.

Solution

Chosen solution: Voice Recovery Coach.

- Voice Recovery Coach appears when ASR confidence is low or the user edits/deletes a submitted voice query within 10 seconds.
- It shows the partial transcript, explains the issue in plain language, offers an editable retry, and gives a contextual tip for Hinglish, background noise, or long queries.
- Voice Learner Mode remains an evaluated alternative direction, not the chosen v1 build.

User Flows/wireframes/mockups

User Flow : [Link](#), Picture (Whimsical)

Wireframes : [Link](#) (Figma)

Prototype : [Link](#) (Loveable)

Key Features

The user benefits that will be developed.

- Live partial transcript so users can self-correct before submitting.
- Recovery Card that turns a silent failure into a guided next step.
- Adaptive Tips for Hinglish mixing, background noise, or long queries.
- Subtle success reinforcement after repeated voice success.
- Failure logging to feed the ASR/STT improvement roadmap.

Key Logic

Algorithm, trigger, and data considerations.

- Recovery trigger: ASR confidence < 0.72 , calibrated in alpha, or rapid post-submit correction/deletion.
- Card dismissal: auto-hide after 8 seconds and show at most once per session.
- Streaming STT: already available in API layer, needs mobile UI surfacing; expected latency around +120ms on 4G+.
- Privacy: partial transcript display and failure logging require voice data handling review.

Launch Readiness

List out the steps leading up to launch.

- Weeks 1-2: design complete for recovery card, live transcript, editable retry, and success reinforcement.
- Weeks 3-5: engineering build for streaming transcript, trigger logic, card component, and event logging.
- Week 6: internal dogfood on Hinglish job-search prompts; tune threshold.
- Week 7: QA, accessibility, privacy review, and low-bandwidth degradation checks.
- Week 8: launch A/B test to eligible new India mobile users.

Experimentation Plan

- 50/50 A/B test: control is current silent failure; treatment is Voice Recovery Coach.
- Primary window: 14 days post-exposure; primary decision metric is D7 repeat voice use.
- Guardrails: session length must not decrease by $> 5\%$, query submission rate must not decrease, dismissal without retry should stay $\leq 70\%$.

Open Questions & Decisions Taken

Keep a note of open questions and decisions for the review process.

- Decision: build Voice Recovery Coach as v1 because it has the strongest impact-confidence-to-effort ratio.
- Decision: keep Voice Learner Mode as an alternative direction to revisit after the VRC A/B test.
- Open: should live transcript be default-on or controlled by a privacy setting?
- Open: how should the experience degrade on 2G or noisy environments?